Phase 11: Letters from Paul

Thirteen letters written by Paul to churches and friends — full of grace, joy, love, and how to live for Jesus.

At a Glance	
Month	Month 11
Books covered	Romans, 1 Corinthians, 2 Corinthians, Galatians, Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians, 1 Thessalonians, 2 Thessalonians, 1 Timothy, 2 Timothy, Titus, Philemon (13 books)
Bible section(s)	Paul's Letters (13)
Big Idea	We are saved by God's grace through faith in Jesus — and that grace changes how we live.
Memory Verse (all ages)	"For it is by grace you have been saved, through faith—and this is not from yourselves, it is the gift of God." — Ephesians 2:8 (NIV)
Little Lambs verse	"It is the gift of God." — Ephesians 2:8
Theme color	Royal Blue (like ink on a letter)
Phase symbol / badge	✉️ The Sealed Scroll badge (a rolled letter tied with a red ribbon and a quill pen)
Running total of books learned	**57 of 66**

> Cross-links: Program Overview · Teacher Training Guide · Books of the Bible Memory System · Game Library · YouTube Video Guide · Phase 11 Printables

The Big Idea (in kid words)

Remember Paul from the book of Acts? He started lots of churches in lots of cities. When he couldn't visit them, he wrote them letters! God's Holy Spirit guided Paul's words, so these letters are part of the Bible. Paul's biggest message is this: we can't earn God's love by being good enough — it is a **free gift** called **grace**. When we trust Jesus, God forgives us, makes us part of His family, and helps us live with love, joy, and kindness.

How this points to Jesus: Every one of Paul's letters is about Jesus — who He is (God's Son, over everything, Colossians 1:15–20), what He did (died for our sins and rose again, 1 Corinthians 15:3–4), and how He lives in us (Galatians 2:20). Paul said, "For to me, to live is Christ" (Philippians 1:21).

The Books in Easy Words

> **Big tip for remembering:** Paul's letters are named after **who they were sent to**. Nine are to **churches** (Romans → 2 Thessalonians) and four are to **friends/pastors** (1 Timothy → Philemon). And the middle four have a famous memory trick: **G-E-P-C = "General Electric Power Company"** (Galatians, Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians).

1. Romans

How to say it	ROH-munz
How to spell it	Ro-mans — R-O-M-A-N-S
Section	Paul's Letters (to a church)
Author	Paul (written down by his helper Tertius, Romans 16:22), from Corinth, about AD 57
Kid summary	Everyone has sinned, but God gives forgiveness and new life as a free gift to everyone who trusts Jesus.
In one word	**Gift**
Key people	Paul, Phoebe (who carried the letter, 16:1–2), Priscilla & Aquila, Abraham (an example of faith, ch. 4)
Key passages	"All have sinned" (3:23); "The wages of sin is death, but the gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord" (6:23); "God demonstrates his own love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us" (5:8); "In all things God works for the good of those who love him" (8:28); nothing can separate us from God's love (8:38–39); "Be transformed by the renewing of your mind" (12:2)
Where Jesus shows up	Jesus is the One who takes our sin and gives us His righteousness (3:22–26).
Hand motion	🛣️ Walk two fingers along your other arm like a road — the "Romans Road" to salvation.

2. 1 Corinthians

How to say it	FIRST kor-IN-thee-unz
How to spell it	Co-rin-thi-ans — C-O-R-I-N-T-H-I-A-N-S
Section	Paul's Letters (to a church)
Author	Paul, from Ephesus, about AD 55
Kid summary	Paul helps a church that is arguing and messing up, and shows them how to love each other and work together like one body.

In one word	**Love**
Key people	Paul, Apollos, Cephas (Peter), Chloe's household
Key passages	One body with many parts (ch. 12); the love chapter — "Love is patient, love is kind" (13:4–7); Jesus rose and appeared to over 500 people (15:3–8)
Where Jesus shows up	Jesus is the foundation of the church (3:11) and the first to rise from the dead (15:20).
Hand motion	❤️ Hold up 1 finger, then make a heart with your hands.

3. 2 Corinthians

How to say it	SEK-und kor-IN-thee-unz
How to spell it	Co-rin-thi-ans — C-O-R-I-N-T-H-I-A-N-S
Section	Paul's Letters (to a church)
Author	Paul, from Macedonia (northern Greece), about AD 56
Kid summary	Paul shares his hard times and shows that God's power is strongest when we feel weak.
In one word	**Strength-in-weakness** (or simply **Weak**)
Key people	Paul, Titus, Timothy
Key passages	"If anyone is in Christ, the new creation has come" (5:17); "God loves a cheerful giver" (9:7); Paul's list of hardships — shipwrecked three times, lowered in a basket (11:23–33); "My grace is sufficient for you, for my power is made perfect in weakness" (12:9)
Where Jesus shows up	Jesus "who had no sin" became sin for us so we could be made right with God (5:21).
Hand motion	💪 Hold up 2 fingers, then make a wobbly weak arm that turns into a strong muscle.

4. Galatians

How to say it	guh-LAY-shunz
How to spell it	Ga-la-tians — G-A-L-A-T-I-A-N-S
Section	Paul's Letters (to churches in the region of Galatia, modern-day Turkey)
Author	Paul, around AD 48–55
Kid summary	We are made right with God by trusting Jesus, not by keeping rules — and the Holy Spirit grows good fruit in our lives.
In one word	**Free**
Key people	Paul, Peter, Barnabas, Titus, Abraham
Key passages	"I have been crucified with Christ and I no longer live, but Christ lives in me" (2:20); "You are all one in Christ Jesus" (3:28); "It is for freedom that Christ has set us free" (5:1); the fruit of the Spirit: love, joy, peace, forbearance, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness and self-control (5:22–23)

Where Jesus shows up	Jesus "loved me and gave himself for me" (2:20).
Hand motion	🍎 Pretend to pick fruit off a tree and take a bite.

5. Ephesians

How to say it	ee-FEE-zhunz
How to spell it	E-phe-sians — E-P-H-E-S-I-A-N-S
Section	Paul's Letters (to a church; written from prison)
Author	Paul, from prison (probably Rome), about AD 60–62
Kid summary	God saved us by grace and made us one big family in Jesus — so put on God's armor and stand strong.
In one word	**Armor**
Key people	Paul, Tychicus (who delivered the letter, 6:21)
Key passages	"By grace you have been saved, through faith" (2:8–9); we are God's handiwork (2:10); "Be kind and compassionate to one another, forgiving each other" (4:32); "Children, obey your parents in the Lord" (6:1); the armor of God — belt of truth, breastplate of righteousness, feet ready with the gospel of peace, shield of faith, helmet of salvation, sword of the Spirit (the word of God) (6:10–18)
Where Jesus shows up	Jesus is the head of the church, and He brings people together (1:22; 2:14).
Hand motion	⛑️ Pretend to put on a helmet, then hold up a shield.

6. Philippians

How to say it	fih-LIP-ee-unz
How to spell it	Phi-lip-pi-ans — P-H-I-L-I-P-P-I-A-N-S (two P's in the middle!)
Section	Paul's Letters (to a church; written from prison)
Author	Paul, from prison (probably Rome), about AD 61–62
Kid summary	Even in jail, Paul is full of joy because Jesus is with him — and he tells us to rejoice too.
In one word	**Joy**
Key people	Paul, Timothy, Epaphroditus, Euodia & Syntyche (two women asked to get along, 4:2)
Key passages	"For to me, to live is Christ and to die is gain" (1:21); Jesus humbled Himself and became a servant (2:5–11); "Rejoice in the Lord always. I will say it again: Rejoice!" (4:4); "Do not be anxious about anything" (4:6); "I can do all this through him who gives me strength" (4:13)

Where Jesus shows up	"At the name of Jesus every knee should bow" (2:10).
Hand motion	😀 Frame your big smile with both hands and bounce.

7. Colossians

How to say it	kuh-LOSH-unz
How to spell it	Co-los-sians — C-O-L-O-S-S-I-A-N-S (two S's in the middle!)
Section	Paul's Letters (to a church; written from prison)
Author	Paul (with Timothy), from prison, about AD 60–62
Kid summary	Jesus is over everything — He made everything and holds it all together — so we don't need anything else to be close to God.
In one word	**Supreme** (or **Over-all**)
Key people	Paul, Timothy, Epaphras (who started the church), Onesimus, Tychicus
Key passages	"The Son is the image of the invisible God… in him all things hold together" (1:15–17); "Set your hearts on things above" (3:1); "Whatever you do, work at it with all your heart, as working for the Lord" (3:23)
Where Jesus shows up	Jesus is Creator, Head of the church, and the One who made peace through His cross (1:15–20).
Hand motion	👑 Point up high, then put a crown on your head — Jesus is King over all.

8. 1 Thessalonians

How to say it	FIRST thess-uh-LOH-nee-unz
How to spell it	Thes-sa-lo-ni-ans — T-H-E-S-S-A-L-O-N-I-A-N-S
Section	Paul's Letters (to a church)
Author	Paul (with Silas and Timothy), from Corinth, about AD 50–51 — one of Paul's earliest letters
Kid summary	Jesus is coming back one day, so keep loving, keep praying, and don't lose hope.
In one word	**Return** (or **Coming**)
Key people	Paul, Silas, Timothy
Key passages	Jesus will come down from heaven with a loud command and the trumpet call of God (4:16–17); "Rejoice always, pray continually, give thanks in all circumstances" (5:16–18)
Where Jesus shows up	Jesus died and rose again, and He is coming back for His people (4:14).
Hand motion	☁️ Hold up 1 finger, then look up and point at the clouds.

9. 2 Thessalonians

How to say it	SEK-und thess-uh-LOH-nee-unz
How to spell it	Thes-sa-lo-ni-ans — T-H-E-S-S-A-L-O-N-I-A-N-S
Section	Paul's Letters (to a church)
Author	Paul (with Silas and Timothy), from Corinth, about AD 51
Kid summary	While we wait for Jesus to come back, we keep working hard and doing good.
In one word	**Wait-and-work** (or **Work**)
Key people	Paul, Silas, Timothy
Key passages	"The Lord is faithful, and he will strengthen you and protect you" (3:3); "Never tire of doing what is good" (3:13)
Where Jesus shows up	Jesus will return in glory and make everything right (1:7–10).
Hand motion	🔨 Hold up 2 fingers, then hammer one fist on the other — keep working!

10. 1 Timothy

How to say it	FIRST TIM-uh-thee
How to spell it	Tim-o-thy — T-I-M-O-T-H-Y
Section	Paul's Letters (to a friend — a young pastor)
Author	Paul, about AD 62–64, to Timothy in Ephesus
Kid summary	Paul coaches his young friend Timothy on how to lead a church and be a good example, even though he is young.
In one word	**Example**
Key people	Paul, Timothy
Key passages	"Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners" (1:15); "Don't let anyone look down on you because you are young, but set an example for the believers in speech, in conduct, in love, in faith and in purity" (4:12)
Where Jesus shows up	Jesus is the one "mediator between God and mankind" (2:5).
Hand motion	👍 Hold up 1 finger, then point to yourself and give a thumbs-up — "I can be an example!"

11. 2 Timothy

How to say it	SEK-und TIM-uh-thee
How to spell it	Tim-o-thy — T-I-M-O-T-H-Y
Section	Paul's Letters (to a friend)
Author	Paul, from prison in Rome, about AD 64–67 — his last letter before he died

Kid summary	In his final letter, Paul tells Timothy to stay strong, keep teaching God's Word, and finish the race.
In one word	**Finish**
Key people	Paul, Timothy, Lois (Timothy's grandmother) and Eunice (his mother) (1:5), Luke ("Only Luke is with me," 4:11), Mark
Key passages	"All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for teaching, rebuking, correcting and training in righteousness" (3:16); "I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith" (4:7)
Where Jesus shows up	Jesus "has destroyed death and has brought life and immortality to light" (1:10).
Hand motion	📖 Hold up 2 fingers, then open your hands like a Bible and blow gently into it — "God-breathed!"

12. Titus

How to say it	TY-tus
How to spell it	Ti-tus — T-I-T-U-S
Section	Paul's Letters (to a friend — a pastor on the island of Crete)
Author	Paul, about AD 62–64
Kid summary	Paul tells Titus to choose good leaders and teach God's people to do what is good because God has been so good to us.
In one word	**Good** (doing good)
Key people	Paul, Titus
Key passages	God's grace teaches us to say "No" to wrong and live upright lives (2:11–12); "He saved us, not because of righteous things we had done, but because of his mercy" (3:5)
Where Jesus shows up	"Our great God and Savior, Jesus Christ" (2:13).
Hand motion	🧱 Stack your fists one on top of the other, like building something good and orderly (Paul left Titus to "put in order" the churches, 1:5).

13. Philemon

How to say it	fy-LEE-mun
How to spell it	Phi-le-mon — P-H-I-L-E-M-O-N
Section	Paul's Letters (to a friend)
Author	Paul, from prison, about AD 60–62 — only 1 chapter (25 verses)
Kid summary	Paul asks his friend Philemon to forgive Onesimus, a runaway slave who became a Christian, and welcome him back as a brother.
In one word	**Forgive**

Key people	Paul, Philemon, Onesimus (o-NESS-ih-mus, means "useful"), Apphia, Archippus
Key passages	"Formerly he was useless to you, but now he has become useful" (v. 11); "no longer as a slave, but better than a slave, as a dear brother" (v. 16); "If he has done you any wrong… charge it to me" (v. 18)
Where Jesus shows up	Paul's offer to pay Onesimus's debt is a picture of what Jesus does for us — He takes our debt on Himself.
Hand motion	🤝 Shake hands with a neighbor and say "Welcome back, brother!"

Teacher Preparation

Background for the teacher

Paul (born Saul in Tarsus) was a highly trained Jewish Pharisee who persecuted Christians until Jesus met him on the road to Damascus (Acts 9). He then spent about 30 years starting churches across the Roman Empire. His 13 letters (called **epistles**) were written to real people facing real problems — arguments, false teaching, fear, suffering, and confusion about Jesus' return. They are arranged in the Bible **roughly from longest to shortest**, first the church letters, then the personal letters — not in the order Paul wrote them. (1 Thessalonians and Galatians are probably the earliest; 2 Timothy is the last.)

Groupings that help:

- **Church letters (9):** Romans, 1 & 2 Corinthians, Galatians, Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians, 1 & 2 Thessalonians
- **Prison letters (4):** Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians, Philemon (+ 2 Timothy, written from a later imprisonment)
- **Pastoral letters (3):** 1 Timothy, 2 Timothy, Titus — instructions for church leaders

Many of these cities appeared in Acts last month: Philippi (Lydia and the jailer, Acts 16), Thessalonica (Acts 17), Corinth (Acts 18), and Ephesus (Acts 19). Connect the dots for the kids — "Remember the jailer? This letter went to his church!"

Key truths to emphasize

1. **Grace:** salvation is a free gift, received by faith, not earned by works (Ephesians 2:8–9; Romans 6:23).
2. **Grace changes us:** good works don't save us, but they are the result of being saved (Ephesians 2:10; Titus 2:11–14).
3. **Jesus is supreme:** He is God, Creator, and Lord over all (Colossians 1:15–20; Philippians 2:5–11).
4. **The church is one body:** every person matters, every gift is needed (1 Corinthians 12).
5. **Love is the greatest:** (1 Corinthians 13:13).
6. **Hope:** Jesus is coming back, and death is not the end (1 Thessalonians 4:13–18; 1 Corinthians 15).

Map notes

Use the same Mediterranean map from Phase 10. Place an envelope icon on each city: **Rome, Corinth, Galatia (region), Ephesus, Philippi, Colossae, Thessalonica, Crete (Titus)**. Timothy was in Ephesus (1 Timothy 1:3); Philemon lived in Colossae (compare Colossians 4:9).

Handling sensitive content by age

Topic	Little Lambs	Explorers	Trailblazers & Ambassadors
Sin and death (Romans 6:23)	"Sin means doing wrong things. Sin separates us from God. But Jesus came to fix it!"	Explain "wages" as what we earn. Emphasize the gift side.	Discuss justice and mercy — God doesn't ignore sin; Jesus pays for it.
Slavery (Philemon)	"Onesimus was a worker who ran away."	"In those days, some people were owned by others as slaves. That was wrong and hurtful. Paul asked Philemon to treat Onesimus as a brother."	Discuss honestly: Roman slavery was common and cruel. Paul condemned slave-trading (1 Timothy 1:10) and taught that in Christ "there is neither slave nor free" (Galatians 3:28). These truths later fueled Christians who fought to end slavery. (See Big Question #3.)
Believers who died (1 Thessalonians 4)	"When people who love Jesus die, they go to be with Jesus, and one day He will make everything new."	Reassure; let kids share about grandparents or pets gently.	Discuss grief "with hope" (4:13) — Christians still feel sad, but not without hope.
Paul's sufferings (2 Corinthians 11)	"Paul had lots of hard days, but God helped him."	Fine to list them — kids love the adventure.	Connect to "power made perfect in weakness."

Common kid questions (with simple answers)

- **"Why did Paul write letters instead of texting?"** — There were no phones! Letters were carried by friends who walked or sailed for weeks. A letter from Paul was a big deal — the whole church would gather to hear it read.
- **"How are letters to other people God's Word for me?"** — The Holy Spirit guided Paul (2 Timothy 3:16). The same truths that helped those churches help us, because people still need Jesus, still argue, still get scared, and still need hope.
- **"What is grace?"** — Grace is getting a good gift you didn't earn. God gives us forgiveness and His love even though we don't deserve it.
- **"If grace is free, can I just do bad stuff?"** — Paul answered that exact question: "By no means!" (Romans 6:1–2). When you love someone who gave you a huge gift, you want to please them.
- **"Did Paul go to jail because he was bad?"** — No. He was arrested for telling people about Jesus. Some people didn't like his message.

- **"What happened to Paul?"** — The Bible doesn't describe his death, but early Christian writers say he was killed in Rome for his faith, around AD 64–67. Before that, he wrote, "I have finished the race" (2 Timothy 4:7). He is with Jesus now.

Month at a Glance

Week	Passage	Lesson Title	Key Point	Video	Game	Activity
1	Romans 3:23; 5:8; 6:23; 10:9; Galatians 5:22–23	The Best Gift Ever	Salvation is a free gift — grace!	📺 "Overview: Romans" (BibleProject); Sharefaith Kids "grace"; Bible Journey "Paul"	🎮 Romans Road Race	Gift Box Verse Craft
2	1 Corinthians 12–13; Ephesians 6:10–18	One Body, Big Love, Strong Armor	Every person matters; love is the greatest; God makes us strong.	📺 "Overview: 1 Corinthians," "Overview: Ephesians"	🎮 Body Parts Scramble / Armor Up Relay	Armor of God Paper Suit
3	Philippians 1; 4; Colossians 1:15–20; 1 Thessalonians 4:13–18	Joy in Chains	Joy comes from Jesus, not from easy days — and He's coming back.	📺 "Overview: Philippians," "Overview: Colossians," "Overview: 1 Thessalonians"	🎮 Joy Jump	Joy Jar
4	1 Timothy 4:12; 2 Timothy 3:14–4:8; Titus 3:4–7; Philemon	Letters to Friends	God uses young people, and forgiveness makes enemies into family.	📺 "Overview: 1 Timothy," "Overview: 2 Timothy," "Overview: Philemon"	🎮 Mail Carrier Dash	Write-a-Letter Station
5 (optional)	All 13 letters	Review & Fun Sunday	57 books — almost there!	Favorite clip replay	🎮 Letter Sort Showdown	Sealed Scroll Badge ceremony

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Weekly Lessons

Week 1 — The Best Gift Ever (Romans & Galatians)

Scripture: Romans 3:23; 5:8; 6:23; 8:38–39; 10:9; 16:1–2, 22; Galatians 5:22–23 **Lesson goal:** Kids will understand that salvation is a free gift from God (grace), received by trusting Jesus.

Opening hook / object lesson — "Earn It or Receive It?" *Supplies:* a beautifully wrapped gift box (inside: a card that reads "GRACE — a gift you can't earn"), a few "chores" cards (sweep, jump 10 times, recite ABCs).

1. Show the gift. "Who wants it?" Offer it to a volunteer — but first say, "You have to earn it! Do these 3 chores." Let them start, then stop them.
2. "Wait — if you earn it, is it still a gift? No! It's a paycheck." Hand them the gift for free.
3. Say: "God's love is like this. We can't earn it. Paul called it **grace** — a gift we receive by trusting Jesus."

Story script:

> Paul was staying in the city of Corinth. He had never been to Rome, the biggest and most important city in the whole world. But there were Christians in Rome, and Paul loved them. He wanted to send them the clearest explanation he could of the good news about Jesus.
>
> So Paul sat down with a friend named Tertius. Paul talked, and Tertius wrote every word with a pen and ink on a long scroll. It was a very long letter — sixteen chapters!
>
> Here is some of what Paul said. "Everyone has sinned." Sin means doing what's wrong and going our own way instead of God's way. Paul said, "All have sinned and fall short of the glory of God." That means nobody is good enough on their own — not kings, not teachers, not even Paul!
>
> "Sin is like a job that pays a terrible paycheck," Paul explained. "The wages of sin is death." That's bad news. But then comes the best news ever: "...but the GIFT of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord!"
>
> How did God give us this gift? Paul wrote, "God showed His love for us like this: while we were still sinners, Christ died for us." Jesus didn't wait for us to get good. He came for us while we were still messing up!
>
> And how do we receive the gift? "If you declare with your mouth, 'Jesus is Lord,' and believe in your heart that God raised Him from the dead, you will be saved."
>
> Paul wanted the Romans to know that once you belong to Jesus, nothing can take you away from His love. "Not death, not life, not angels, not anything in all creation can separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord!"
>
> When the letter was done, a brave woman named Phoebe carried it all the way to Rome — over land and sea. Imagine the church gathering to hear it read out loud for the first time!
>
> In another letter, to the churches in Galatia, Paul explained what happens after we receive God's gift: the Holy Spirit grows "fruit" in our lives — love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control. We don't grow good fruit to earn God's love. We grow it because God's love is already living in us!

Age-group teaching tips

- **Little Lambs:** Pass the gift box around while singing; whoever holds it when the music stops says, "Jesus is a gift!" Focus phrase: "It is the gift of God."
- **Explorers:** Teach the **Romans Road** with 4 signposts on the wall: 3:23 (everyone sinned), 6:23 (sin pays death, God gives a gift), 5:8 (Jesus died for us), 10:9 (believe and say "Jesus is Lord"). Walk the road together.
- **Trailblazers:** Look up Galatians 5:22–23 and list the nine fruits. Which one is easiest for you? Hardest? Compare with "acts of the flesh" (5:19–21).
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss "justified by faith" (Romans 5:1). What does "justified" mean (declared right/not guilty)? Why couldn't the law save us (Romans 3:20; Galatians 2:16)? Practice walking a younger child through the Romans Road.

Discussion questions

- *Little Lambs:* 1) What is a gift? 2) What gift does God give us? (Jesus / forever life with Him.) 3) Can anything stop God from loving you? (No!)
- *Explorers:* 1) What does "all have sinned" mean? 2) Why is God's gift better than a paycheck? 3) Who carried Paul's letter to Rome?
- *Trailblazers:* 1) Why do people try to earn God's love? 2) What's the difference between doing good to *get* God's love and doing good *because* we have it? 3) Which fruit of the Spirit do you want God to grow in you this month?
- *Ambassadors:* 1) Romans 8:28 is often quoted — what does it promise, and what doesn't it promise? 2) Why does Paul say "while we were *still* sinners"? Why does that matter? 3) How would you explain grace to a friend who thinks God grades on a curve?

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "grace" / "fruit of the Spirit" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=fruit+of+the+Spirit | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "Paul" / "Romans" | https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Paul | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers & Ambassadors | "Overview: Romans 1–4" and "Overview: Romans 5–16"; "Overview: Galatians" | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Overview+Romans |

Teacher: Preview every video before class. Follow-up questions: 1) What is the "gift of God"? 2) What do we have to do to receive a gift?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Romans Road Race* (see Games). ✂️ **Activity of the week:** *Gift Box Verse Craft* (see Activities & Crafts). 🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** Learn the memory verse (Ephesians 2:8) with motions. Learn "Romans, First and Second Corinthians." Spell R-O-M-A-N-S. 🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> "Thank You, God, for the gift of Jesus. I can't earn Your love, but You give it to me free! Please grow good fruit in my life. Amen."

Week 2 — One Body, Big Love, Strong Armor (1 & 2 Corinthians, Ephesians)

Scripture: 1 Corinthians 12:12–27; 13:1–13; 2 Corinthians 12:9; Ephesians 6:10–18 **Lesson goal:** Kids will learn that every believer is an important part of Christ's body, that love is the greatest, and that God gives us armor to stand strong.

Opening hook / object lesson — "The Silly Body" *Supplies:* a large paper cut-out of a person, extra paper "ears" (lots of them), tape.

1. Tape ten ears all over the paper body. "What if the whole body was an EAR? How would it see? Smell? Walk?"
2. Kids laugh. Say: "Paul wrote to a church where people were saying, 'I'm more important than you!' Paul said, 'You're like a body — every part is needed!'"

Story script:

> In the city of Corinth there was a church Paul had started. Paul stayed there a year and a half, teaching about Jesus. But after he left, the church started having problems. People were arguing. Some said, "I follow Paul!" Others said, "I follow Apollos!" Some thought they were more important because they had flashy gifts. Others felt left out.
>
> So Paul wrote them a letter. He said, "You are like a body. A body has many parts — eyes, ears, hands, feet. What if the foot said, 'I'm not a hand, so I don't belong'? It would still be part of the body! What if the whole body were one big eye? How would it hear? God put each part where He wanted it. You are the body of Christ, and each one of you is a part of it."
>
> Then Paul wrote something so beautiful that people still read it at weddings today. "If I can speak every language, even like angels, but don't have love, I'm just a noisy gong! Love is patient. Love is kind. It does not envy. It does not boast. It is not proud. It keeps no record of wrongs. Love never fails!" And Paul ended, "Faith, hope, and love — but the greatest of these is love."
>
> Later, Paul wrote them another letter. He told them about his hard times: he'd been beaten, shipwrecked three times, gone hungry, and even lowered in a basket through a wall to escape. Paul also had something painful he called a "thorn in my flesh." Three times he asked God to take it away. But God said, "My grace is enough for you. My power is made perfect in weakness." Paul learned that when he felt weak, God's strength showed up even more!
>
> Years later, while he was chained to a Roman soldier, Paul wrote to the church in Ephesus. Maybe he looked at that soldier's armor and got an idea. "Put on the full armor of God," he wrote, "so you can stand strong!" There's the **belt of truth**, the **breastplate of righteousness**, **shoes** ready to share the **gospel of peace**, the **shield of faith**, the **helmet of salvation**, and the **sword of the Spirit**, which is the **Word of God**. And don't forget — pray at all times!

Age-group teaching tips

- **Little Lambs:** Point to body parts: "Eyes! Ears! Hands! Feet! Every part is important — and YOU are important in God's family!" Put on pretend armor piece by piece with big motions.

- **Explorers:** Read 1 Corinthians 13:4–7, replacing "love" with "Jesus." Then replace it with your own name — "Sam is patient, Sam is kind..." Is it true? Pray for God's help.
- **Trailblazers:** Match each piece of Roman armor to its spiritual meaning; discuss why the sword (God's Word) is the only "attack" piece.
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss spiritual gifts (1 Corinthians 12:4–11; Romans 12:6–8). What gifts do you see in each other? Discuss why Paul put the love chapter right in the middle of a discussion about gifts.

Discussion questions

- *Little Lambs:* 1) Is every part of your body important? 2) Are you important in God's family? (Yes!) 3) What is the greatest thing? (Love!)
- *Explorers:* 1) Why was the church in Corinth arguing? 2) What are three things love does or doesn't do? 3) Name three pieces of God's armor.
- *Trailblazers:* 1) What does it mean that the church is "the body of Christ"? 2) Which part of "love is..." is hardest for you? 3) What did God mean by "My power is made perfect in weakness"?
- *Ambassadors:* 1) How can cliques in a youth group be like the problems in Corinth? 2) What "battles" are teens facing, and which armor piece helps most? 3) How can weakness actually be a gift?

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "armor of God" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=armor+of+God | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "Paul Corinth" / "armor of God" | https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=armor+of+God | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers & Ambassadors | "Overview: 1 Corinthians," "Overview: 2 Corinthians," "Overview: Ephesians" | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Overview+Ephesians |

Teacher: Preview every video before class. Follow-up questions: 1) Which piece of armor would you want most, and why? 2) How can you show love this week?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Armor Up Relay* and *Body Parts Scramble* (see Games). ✂️ **Activity of the week:** *Armor of God Paper Suit* (see Activities & Crafts). 🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** Add "Galatians, Ephesians" (G-E of "General Electric"). Spell C-O-R-I-N-T-H-I-A-N-S (Explorers+), E-P-H-E-S-I-A-N-S. 🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> "Dear God, thank You that I'm an important part of Your family. Help me to be patient and kind. Help me put on Your armor and stand strong. Amen."

Week 3 — Joy in Chains (Philippians, Colossians, 1 & 2 Thessalonians)

Scripture: Philippians 1:12–14, 21; 2:25–30; 4:4–13; Colossians 1:15–20; 1 Thessalonians 4:13–18; 5:16–18
Lesson goal: Kids will learn that real joy comes from Jesus, who is over everything, and that we have hope because He is coming back.

Opening hook / object lesson — "Joy on the Inside" *Supplies:* a can of soda (or bottle of sparkling water), a clear cup, a bag of sugar cubes or a lemon; OR a glow stick.

- Glow stick version: Show an un-cracked glow stick. "It's kind of boring." Turn off the lights and crack it — it glows! "The darker it gets, the brighter it shines. Paul was in a dark place — chained up in prison — but his joy in Jesus shone bright!"

Story script:

> Paul was under arrest in Rome. He lived in a house, but a Roman soldier guarded him all day, and Paul was chained. He couldn't travel. He couldn't visit his churches. Some people would be grumpy, sad, or angry. But Paul did something surprising — he wrote a letter about JOY!
>
> The letter was to his friends in Philippi. Remember them? That's where Lydia believed, and where Paul and Silas sang in jail and the jailer's family got saved! The Philippian church loved Paul. They sent a man named Epaphroditus with gifts to help him. But Epaphroditus got so sick he almost died! God had mercy and healed him, and Paul sent him home carrying the letter.
>
> Paul wrote, "Don't worry about me! Because I'm in chains, the whole palace guard has heard about Jesus! And other Christians are getting braver." Paul said, "For me, to live is Christ, and to die is gain." In other words, "If I live, I get to serve Jesus. If I die, I get to be with Jesus. Either way, I win!"
>
> Then Paul wrote, "Rejoice in the Lord always! I'll say it again: Rejoice!" and "Don't worry about anything; instead, pray about everything." And, "I have learned to be content whether I have a lot or a little. I can do all this through Him who gives me strength."
>
> About the same time, Paul wrote to the church in Colossae. Some people there were saying Jesus wasn't enough. Paul wrote, "Jesus is the image of the invisible God! Everything was made through Him and for Him. He holds all things together!" If Jesus holds the whole universe together, He can hold *us* together too.
>
> Years earlier, Paul had written to the church in Thessalonica. Those believers were sad because some of their Christian friends had died. They wondered, "Will we ever see them again?" Paul comforted them: "We don't grieve like people who have no hope. Jesus died and rose again, and one day the Lord Himself will come down from heaven with a loud command and the trumpet call of God. Those who died believing in Jesus will rise, and we will all be with the Lord forever! So encourage each other with these words."
>
> No wonder Paul could write, "Rejoice always, pray continually, give thanks in all circumstances!"

Age-group teaching tips

- **Little Lambs:** Sing "I've Got the Joy, Joy, Joy, Joy Down in My Heart." Practice "Rejoice!" as a jump-and-cheer. Short truth: "Jesus makes me happy inside, even on sad days."
- **Explorers:** Play "Glad / Sad / Still Glad": Teacher names a bad situation ("Your ice cream fell!"). Kids say one reason they can still have joy in Jesus.

- **Trailblazers:** Read Philippians 4:6–7 and practice turning worries into prayers. Write a worry on one side of a card and a prayer on the other.
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss "content" (Philippians 4:11–13). Is Philippians 4:13 about winning sports games? (In context it's about being content in need or plenty.) Discuss Colossians 1:15–20 as one of the earliest Christian statements that Jesus is God.

Discussion questions

- *Little Lambs:* 1) Where was Paul when he wrote about joy? (In chains!) 2) Who gives us joy? (Jesus.) 3) Who is coming back one day? (Jesus!)
- *Explorers:* 1) How did Paul's chains actually help spread the gospel? 2) What does Philippians 4:6 tell us to do instead of worrying? 3) Why were the Thessalonians sad, and what did Paul tell them?
- *Trailblazers:* 1) What's the difference between happiness and joy? 2) What does "He holds all things together" mean for your life? 3) How can you "give thanks in all circumstances" — even bad ones?
- *Ambassadors:* 1) What does Philippians 4:13 really mean in context? 2) How does hope in Jesus' return change the way Christians handle grief? 3) Paul says "to die is gain." How can that be true without being morbid?

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "joy" / "Paul in prison" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=joy | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "Paul in Rome" | https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Paul+Rome | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers & Ambassadors | "Overview: Philippians," "Overview: Colossians," "Overview: 1 Thessalonians," "Overview: 2 Thessalonians" | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Overview+Philippians |

Teacher: Preview every video before class. Follow-up questions: 1) How can you rejoice when you're having a hard day? 2) What will happen when Jesus comes back?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Joy Jump* (see Games). ✂️ **Activity of the week:** *Joy Jar* (see Activities & Crafts). 🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** Add "Philippians, Colossians, First and Second Thessalonians." Spell P-H-I-L-I-P-P-I-A-N-S (two P's!) and C-O-L-O-S-S-I-A-N-S (two S's!). Little Lambs: "Rejoice!" 🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> "Jesus, You hold everything together. Thank You for giving me joy, even on hard days. Thank You that You are coming back! Amen."

Week 4 — Letters to Friends (1 & 2 Timothy, Titus, Philemon)

Scripture: 1 Timothy 4:12; 2 Timothy 1:5; 3:14–17; 4:6–8; Titus 3:4–7; Philemon 1–25 **Lesson goal:** Kids will learn that God uses young people and that forgiveness turns enemies into family.

Opening hook / object lesson — "The Debt Note" *Supplies:* a paper "bill" that reads "OWES: $1,000,000," a red marker, an envelope.

1. Hand a volunteer the bill. "Oh no — you owe a million dollars! Can you pay it?" (No!)
2. Take the red marker and write across it: "CHARGE IT TO ME. — Paul." "Today we'll read a letter where Paul says, 'If he owes you anything, charge it to me.' That's what Jesus does for us!"

Story script:

> Paul had a lot of friends, and some of his letters were written just to them.
>
> One friend was **Timothy**. Timothy grew up in a town called Lystra. His grandmother Lois and his mother Eunice taught him the Scriptures from the time he was a little boy. When Paul visited, Timothy believed in Jesus and began traveling with Paul. Paul called him "my true son in the faith."
>
> When Timothy became a pastor in Ephesus, he was pretty young. Maybe some people said, "You're just a kid! What do you know?" So Paul wrote, "Don't let anyone look down on you because you are young, but set an example for the believers in speech, in conduct, in love, in faith, and in purity." God uses young people!
>
> Later, Paul was in prison again, and this time he knew he would probably die soon. He wrote one last letter to Timothy: "Keep going in what you learned. All Scripture is God-breathed. Preach the Word! I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith. Now there is a crown waiting for me." Paul also wrote, "Come see me soon. Bring my coat and my scrolls. Only Luke is with me."
>
> Another friend was **Titus**, who was helping churches on the island of Crete. Paul told him, "Remind people to be kind and ready to do good — because God our Savior was kind to us. He saved us, not because of the good things we did, but because of His mercy."
>
> And then there's the shortest letter: **Philemon**. Philemon was a rich Christian who had a church meeting in his house. He also had a slave named Onesimus. One day, Onesimus ran away — and he may have taken something too. He ran all the way to the big city of Rome.
>
> Guess who Onesimus met there? Paul! Paul told him about Jesus, and Onesimus became a Christian. His name meant "useful," and now he really was useful — he helped Paul a lot.
>
> But Onesimus needed to make things right. So Paul sent him back home with a letter for Philemon: "I'm sending him back to you — not as a slave anymore, but as a dear brother. Welcome him like you would welcome me. If he owes you anything, charge it to me. I'll pay it back!"
>
> Can you imagine Philemon reading that letter with Onesimus standing right in front of him? That's the power of the gospel: Jesus forgives us and makes us brothers and sisters — and He paid what we owed.

Age-group teaching tips

- **Little Lambs:** Act out the Philemon story with two puppets: running away, saying sorry, getting a hug. "God forgives us, and we forgive others."

- **Explorers:** Brainstorm ways kids can "set an example" in each area: speech, conduct (actions), love, faith, purity. Write them on a hand outline (five fingers = five areas).
- **Trailblazers:** Read all of Philemon (it's short — 25 verses). Find where Paul is gentle, where he is persuasive, and where he offers to pay. Compare Philemon 18 with 2 Corinthians 5:21.
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss 2 Timothy 3:16–17 — what does "God-breathed" mean for how we treat the Bible? Write a "Paul-style" letter of encouragement to a younger kid in the class.

Discussion questions

- *Little Lambs:* 1) Who taught Timothy about God when he was little? (His grandma and mom.) 2) Can God use kids? (Yes!) 3) What did Paul ask Philemon to do? (Forgive / welcome Onesimus.)
- *Explorers:* 1) What five ways did Paul say Timothy could be an example? 2) Why did Onesimus have to go back? 3) How is Paul saying "charge it to me" like what Jesus did?
- *Trailblazers:* 1) Why do you think Paul's last letter talks so much about God's Word? 2) What does it mean to "finish the race"? 3) Who is someone you need to forgive or ask forgiveness from?
- *Ambassadors:* 1) How can a teenager be a leader in church now? 2) What would it have cost Philemon to obey Paul? 3) How should the gospel change the way we treat people with less power or status?

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "Timothy" / "forgiveness" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=forgiveness | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "Onesimus" / "Philemon" / "Timothy" | https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Philemon | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers & Ambassadors | "Overview: 1 Timothy," "Overview: 2 Timothy," "Overview: Titus," "Overview: Philemon" | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Overview+Philemon |

Teacher: Preview every video before class. Follow-up questions: 1) How did Paul help Onesimus and Philemon become friends? 2) How can you be an example this week?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Mail Carrier Dash* (see Games). ✂️ **Activity of the week:** *Write-a-Letter Station* (see Activities & Crafts). 🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** Add "First and Second Timothy, Titus, Philemon." All 13 letters with motions! Spell T-I-M-O-T-H-Y, T-I-T-U-S, P-H-I-L-E-M-O-N. 🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> "Dear God, thank You that You can use me even though I'm young. Thank You that Jesus paid what I owed. Help me forgive others like You forgave me. Amen."

Week 5 (optional) — Review & Fun Sunday

Use the End-of-Phase Review plan below: Letter Sort Showdown, oral check-offs, Bible Passport stamps, and the Sealed Scroll badge.

Book Memory Song & Motions

🎵 Paul's Letters Song — tune: *"Old MacDonald Had a Farm"*

> 🎵 **Verse 1: Letters to Churches** *Paul wrote letters to the church, Thirteen letters — WHOA! Romans, First and Second Corinthians, Thirteen letters — WHOA! Galatians here, Ephesians there, Philippians, Colossians — everywhere! First and Second Thessalonians, Thirteen letters — WHOA!*
>
> **Verse 2: Letters to Friends** *Paul wrote letters to his friends, Thirteen letters — WHOA! First and Second Timothy, Thirteen letters — WHOA! With a Titus here and a Philemon there, Here a letter, there a letter, everywhere a letter, letter! Paul wrote letters to his friends, Thirteen letters — WHOA!*
>
> *(Shout:)* **"THIRTEEN LETTERS FROM PAUL!"**

Tip: Sing "Romans, First and Second Corinthians" fast, to fit the line "And on that farm he had a cow." "Galatians here, Ephesians there" fits "With a moo-moo here and a moo-moo there." Practice slowly first, then faster! Throw your arms wide on every "WHOA!"

Bonus chant for the middle four — "General Electric Power Company":

> *G — Galatians! E — Ephesians! P — Philippians! C — Colossians! General Electric Power Company — G, E, P, C!*

🎵 The Cumulative Book Chant (Books 1–57)

Clap-clap-slap rhythm. (Classes may also sing each section to the tune they learned in that phase — see the Memory System.)

> **OLD TESTAMENT!** *(arms wide like an open book)*
>
> Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy — **"FIVE books of LAW!"** *(5 fingers)*
>
> Joshua, Judges, Ruth, First and Second Samuel, First and Second Kings, First and Second Chronicles, Ezra, Nehemiah, Esther — **"TWELVE books of HISTORY!"**
>
> Job, Psalms, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, Song of Songs — **"FIVE books of POETRY!"** *(air harp)*
>
> Isaiah, Jeremiah, Lamentations, Ezekiel, Daniel — **"FIVE MAJOR PROPHETS!"** *(big muscles)*
>
> Hosea, Joel, Amos, Obadiah, Jonah, Micah, Nahum, Habakkuk, Zephaniah, Haggai, Zechariah, Malachi — **"TWELVE MINOR PROPHETS!"** *(pinky muscle)*
>
> **"THIRTY-NINE in the OLD!"**
>
> **NEW TESTAMENT!**

> Matthew, Mark, Luke, John — **"FOUR GOSPELS!"** *(cross)*
>
> Acts — **"ONE book of HISTORY — THE CHURCH IS BORN!"** *(flame and go)*
>
> Romans, First and Second Corinthians, Galatians, Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians, First and Second Thessalonians, First and Second Timothy, Titus, Philemon — **"THIRTEEN LETTERS FROM PAUL!"** *(pretend to write with a quill, then fold a letter)*
>
> **"FIFTY-SEVEN — ALMOST THERE!"** *(jump!)*

Hand motions for each letter

#	Book	Motion
1	Romans	Walk fingers along your arm (Romans Road)
2	1 Corinthians	1 finger, then a heart (love chapter)
3	2 Corinthians	2 fingers, then a wobbly arm becoming a strong muscle
4	Galatians	Pick fruit and take a bite
5	Ephesians	Put on a helmet, hold up a shield
6	Philippians	Frame a big smile and bounce (joy)
7	Colossians	Point up, then put on a crown (Jesus over all)
8	1 Thessalonians	1 finger, look up and point to clouds
9	2 Thessalonians	2 fingers, hammer fists (keep working)
10	1 Timothy	1 finger, point to self + thumbs-up (be an example)
11	2 Timothy	2 fingers, open-book hands + blow ("God-breathed")
12	Titus	Stack fists (put things in order, do good)
13	Philemon	Shake hands ("Welcome back, brother!")

Section Shout

Teacher: "How many letters did Paul write?" **Kids:** "THIRTEEN! NINE to CHURCHES and FOUR to FRIENDS!"

Cumulative recall drill (5 minutes)

1. **Echo round** for Paul's letters, then the whole chant.
2. **Churches or Friends?** Teacher calls a letter; kids point to the "Churches" wall or "Friends" wall.
3. **Number line-up:** Hand 13 kids a letter card each (shuffled). Class arranges them in order in under 60 seconds.
4. **What's missing?** Teacher says the 13 letters but skips one; first to name the missing one wins.
5. **Full chant challenge:** All 57 in under 75 seconds.

Tips for each age group

- **Little Lambs:** Learn "Romans" and "Philemon" (first and last) plus the "Thirteen letters from Paul!" shout. Do the motions with older buddies.
- **Explorers:** Learn all 13 with the song; master the two tricky spellings (Philippians, Colossians).
- **Trailblazers:** Know all 57 in order and which letters were written from prison.
- **Ambassadors:** Lead the chant; quiz younger kids; explain the GEPC trick to them.

Spelling & Reading

Spelling lists by age group

Little Lambs (letter recognition & sound it out)

- First letters: **R** for Romans, **G** for Galatians (and Gift!), **J** for Joy, **L** for Love and Letter, **T** for Timothy and Titus.
- Sound it out: T-I-T-U-S ("Ti... tus") and J-O-Y.
- Trace **PAUL** and **LOVE** on the printable.

Explorers (book names)

- Romans, Corinthians, Galatians, Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians, Thessalonians, Timothy, Titus, Philemon

Trailblazers (book names + 5 vocab words)

- All 13 letters (with "First" and "Second" written as numbers: 1 Corinthians, 2 Corinthians...)
- Vocab: **grace** (a gift we don't earn), **faith** (trusting God), **epistle** (a letter in the Bible), **armor** (protection for battle), **rejoice** (to be full of joy and praise)

Ambassadors (book names + harder vocab with definitions)

- All 57 books so far
- **justification** — being declared "not guilty" and right with God through faith in Jesus
- **redemption** — being bought back / set free by a payment (Jesus' death)
- **reconciliation** — making peace between two who were enemies (us and God; Philemon and Onesimus)
- **sanctification** — the process of being made more like Jesus
- **contentment** — being satisfied in Christ whether you have a lot or a little

Syllable-clap method

Word	Claps
Ro-mans	2
Co-rin-thi-ans	4

Word	Claps
Ga-la-tians	3
E-phe-sians	3
Phi-lip-pi-ans	4
Co-los-sians	3
Thes-sa-lo-ni-ans	5 (the champion!)
Tim-o-thy	3
Ti-tus	2
Phi-le-mon	3

"Spell It Out" relay

Supplies: Letter cards in two colors (one set per team), two "mailbag" baskets, tape line.

1. Each team's mailbag holds the scrambled letters of a book name.
2. Teacher calls the book ("PHILIPPIANS!"). Runners take turns grabbing one letter at a time and building the word on the floor.
3. When finished, the whole team spells it aloud and does that book's motion.
4. Little Lambs: hunt for just the first letter. Ambassadors: build "THESSALONIANS" or "SANCTIFICATION."

Mini spelling bee word list

Word	Use it in a sentence
Paul	"Paul wrote thirteen letters in the Bible."
grace	"Grace is a gift we don't earn."
love	"Love is patient and kind."
joy	"Paul had joy even in prison."
Romans	"Romans says the gift of God is eternal life."
Titus	"Titus helped churches on the island of Crete."
Timothy	"Timothy learned the Scriptures from his grandmother and mother."
armor	"Put on the full armor of God."
Galatians	"Galatians tells about the fruit of the Spirit."
Ephesians	"Ephesians says we are saved by grace through faith."
Philippians	"Philippians tells us to rejoice in the Lord always."
Colossians	"Colossians says Jesus holds all things together."
Philemon	"Philemon was asked to welcome Onesimus as a brother."
Thessalonians	"Thessalonians teaches that Jesus is coming back."

Word	Use it in a sentence
justification	"Justification means God declares us right with Him through faith."

Read-aloud practice passage

> **1 Corinthians 13:4–8a (NIV):** "Love is patient, love is kind. It does not envy, it does not boast, it is not proud. It does not dishonor others, it is not self-seeking, it is not easily angered, it keeps no record of wrongs. Love does not delight in evil but rejoices with the truth. It always protects, always trusts, always hopes, always perseveres. Love never fails."
>
> *Little Lambs:* echo "Love is patient, love is kind" with hand motions (hands folded for patient; hug yourself for kind).

Word Trivia

⭐ Easy (Little Lambs / Explorers)

1. Who wrote 13 letters in the Bible?
2. Fill in the blank: "It is the _____ of God." (Ephesians 2:8)
3. What is the "greatest" of faith, hope, and love?
4. True or False: Paul wrote some letters while he was in prison.
5. What did Paul tell the Philippians to do "always"? (Rejoice!)
6. What do we put on to stand strong: the armor of _____?
7. Fill in the blank: "Love is patient, love is _____."
8. True or False: We can earn God's love by being really, really good.
9. Who is coming back one day, according to Thessalonians?
10. What was the first letter of Paul's in the Bible?

⭐⭐ Medium (Explorers / Trailblazers)

11. What is the last of Paul's letters in the Bible order?
12. Which book? It talks about the "fruit of the Spirit."
13. Name three fruits of the Spirit.
14. Which book has the "love chapter"?
15. Who carried the letter of Romans to Rome?
16. Which book? "I can do all this through him who gives me strength."
17. Who were Timothy's grandmother and mother?
18. Fill in the blank: "The wages of sin is death, but the gift of God is _____ _____ in Christ Jesus our Lord." (Romans 6:23)
19. What is the "sword of the Spirit"?
20. Who ran away from Philemon?
21. Which book? "Don't let anyone look down on you because you are young."
22. What do the letters G-E-P-C stand for?

23. True or False: Paul's letters are in the Bible in the order he wrote them.
24. How many chapters does Philemon have?

⭐⭐⭐ Hard (Trailblazers / Ambassadors)

25. Who said it? "I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith."
26. Who actually wrote down the words of Romans as Paul spoke them?
27. What did God tell Paul when he asked three times for his "thorn" to be removed?
28. Name all six pieces of the armor of God.
29. Which four letters are often called the "Prison Letters"?
30. Which three letters are called the "Pastoral Letters"?
31. Which book? "The Son is the image of the invisible God."
32. What does the name "Onesimus" mean?
33. Fill in the blank: "All Scripture is **-**." (2 Timothy 3:16)
34. Which book? "If anyone is in Christ, the new creation has come."
35. On what island was Titus serving?
36. Who brought gifts from Philippi to Paul and then got very sick?
37. In 1 Corinthians 15, how many people at one time did Jesus appear to after He rose?
38. True or False: Paul offered to pay whatever Onesimus owed.
39. Which letter did Paul write last, shortly before he died?
40. Which book? "Rejoice always, pray continually, give thanks in all circumstances."

Answer key

1. Paul. 2. gift. 3. Love (1 Corinthians 13:13). 4. True. 5. Rejoice in the Lord (Philippians 4:4). 6. God. 7. kind. 8. False — it's a free gift (Ephesians 2:8–9). 9. Jesus. 10. Romans.
2. Philemon. 12. Galatians (5:22–23). 13. Any three: love, joy, peace, forbearance (patience), kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control. 14. 1 Corinthians (ch. 13). 15. Phoebe (Romans 16:1–2). 16. Philippians (4:13). 17. Lois and Eunice (2 Timothy 1:5). 18. eternal life. 19. The word of God (Ephesians 6:17). 20. Onesimus. 21. 1 Timothy (4:12). 22. Galatians, Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians ("General Electric Power Company"). 23. False — church letters are first, roughly longest to shortest, then letters to individuals. 24. One.
3. Paul (2 Timothy 4:7). 26. Tertius (Romans 16:22). 27. "My grace is sufficient for you, for my power is made perfect in weakness" (2 Corinthians 12:9). 28. Belt of truth, breastplate of righteousness, feet fitted with the readiness of the gospel of peace, shield of faith, helmet of salvation, sword of the Spirit. 29. Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians, Philemon. 30. 1 Timothy, 2 Timothy, Titus. 31. Colossians (1:15). 32. "Useful." 33. God-breathed. 34. 2 Corinthians (5:17). 35. Crete (Titus 1:5). 36. Epaphroditus (Philippians 2:25–30). 37. More than 500 (15:6). 38. True (Philemon 18–19). 39. 2 Timothy. 40. 1 Thessalonians (5:16–18).

Games

🎮 1. Romans Road Race

- **Best for:** Explorers, Trailblazers (Little Lambs with buddies)

- **Supplies:** Four large "road signs" (3:23, 6:23, 5:8, 10:9) posted around the room, tape "road" lines, paper "cars" or just running feet
- **Setup:** Place signs in a loop. At each sign, a card says what the verse means in kid words.
- **How to play:** Teams race from sign to sign. At each sign, they must say the meaning ("Everyone sinned!") before running on. At the finish, they shout the memory verse.
- **How to win:** First team to complete the road and say Ephesians 2:8 together.
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* just shout one word at each sign (Sin! Gift! Jesus! Believe!). *Older:* must quote each verse from memory.
- **Learning goal:** The gospel in four steps; grace.

🎮 2. Armor Up Relay

- **Best for:** All ages
- **Supplies:** Two sets of "armor": a belt (rope or old belt), a breastplate (paper grocery bag with arm holes), shoes (big adult slippers), a shield (paper plate or cardboard), a helmet (plastic bowl or hat), a sword (rolled-up newspaper or Bible). Labels on each.
- **Setup:** Armor piles at the far end of the room for each team.
- **How to play:** Runner 1 runs to the pile, puts on the belt, says "Belt of truth!" and runs back. Runner 2 grabs the breastplate, and so on, until one teammate is fully dressed. That "soldier" must then say Ephesians 6:11 ("Put on the full armor of God...") or just "I'm ready!"
- **How to win:** First fully armored soldier wins.
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* teacher helps put armor on. *Older:* each runner must also name a real-life way to use that piece.
- **Learning goal:** The six pieces of God's armor (Ephesians 6).

🎮 3. Body Parts Scramble

- **Best for:** Little Lambs & Explorers
- **Supplies:** None (or cards with body parts drawn on them)
- **How to play:** Teacher calls out two body parts: "Elbow to knee!" Kids find a partner and touch those parts together. When the teacher shouts "ONE BODY!" everyone joins in one giant group hug/huddle and shouts, "We are the body of Christ!" Then the teacher calls a Paul letter, and kids shout the next one.
- **How to win:** Everyone wins when the whole class is one body!
- **Adaptations:** *Older:* add "Name a spiritual gift!" challenges.
- **Learning goal:** 1 Corinthians 12 — we need each other.

🎮 4. Joy Jump

- **Best for:** All ages
- **Supplies:** Open space, a list of situations
- **How to play:** Teacher reads a situation. If it's a *happy* situation, kids jump and shout "Rejoice!" If it's a *hard* situation, kids crouch — then the teacher says "But Jesus is still with me!" and everyone springs up and shouts "Rejoice ANYWAY!" Between rounds, call a Paul letter; kids answer "Church!" or "Friend!"
- **How to win:** This is a cooperative game; the goal is for everyone to jump together.

- **Adaptations:** *Older:* kids must say a verse from Philippians after each "Rejoice anyway!"
- **Learning goal:** Joy in every circumstance (Philippians 4:4; 1 Thessalonians 5:16–18).

🎮 5. Mail Carrier Dash

- **Best for:** Explorers, Trailblazers, Ambassadors
- **Supplies:** 13 envelopes, each labeled with one letter of Paul (Romans → Philemon), 9 "church" mailboxes (shoeboxes labeled Rome, Corinth, Corinth, Galatia, Ephesus, Philippi, Colossae, Thessalonica, Thessalonica) and 4 "friend" mailboxes (Timothy, Timothy, Titus, Philemon)
- **Setup:** Spread mailboxes around the room. Put envelopes in a central "post office."
- **How to play:** Teams of mail carriers race to deliver each envelope to the correct mailbox. Then they must line up all 13 envelopes in Bible order.
- **How to win:** Fastest correct delivery + correct order.
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* only deliver 4 (Romans, Ephesians, Philippians, Philemon) with picture clues. *Older:* add a third step — say one key verse from each letter.
- **Learning goal:** Who each letter was written to; order of the books.

🎮 6. Letter Sort Showdown (Review Sunday)

- **Best for:** Mixed-age teams
- **Supplies:** Two sets of all 57 book cards, color-coded by section
- **How to play:** Teams race to put all 57 books (or just the New Testament 18 for younger teams) in order. Midway, the teacher shouts "Section Shout!" and teams must stop and do the Section Shout for a section they've completed.
- **How to win:** First complete and correct line wins; bonus points for each correct "In one word" given for a Paul letter.
- **Learning goal:** Cumulative review.

Coloring Pages

🖍️ **Coloring page 1 — Paul Writes a Letter (Week 1)** *Scene:* Paul sitting by an oil lamp speaking, while his helper Tertius writes on a long scroll with a feather pen; Phoebe standing in the doorway with a traveling bag, ready to carry it. *Caption:* "The gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord." — Romans 6:23 *Coloring conversation:* What gift has God given you? Who could you send a kind letter to?

🖍️ **Coloring page 2 — Fruit of the Spirit Tree (Week 1)** *Scene:* A big tree with nine fruits, each labeled: love, joy, peace, forbearance, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control. *Caption:* "The fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace..." — Galatians 5:22 *Coloring conversation:* Which fruit do you want God to grow in you this week?

🖍️ **Coloring page 3 — The Armor of God (Week 2)** *Scene:* A kid dressed in Roman armor, each piece labeled (belt of truth, breastplate of righteousness, shoes of peace, shield of faith, helmet of salvation, sword of the Spirit). *Caption:* "Put on the full armor of God." — Ephesians 6:11 *Coloring conversation:* Which piece do you need most today?

🖍️ **Coloring page 4 — Joy in Chains (Week 3)** *Scene:* Paul smiling as he writes, with a chain on his wrist connected to a Roman guard; big letters "REJOICE!" floating above. *Caption:* "Rejoice in the Lord always." — Philippians 4:4 *Coloring conversation:* Why was Paul happy even in chains? What makes you joyful?

🖍️ **Coloring page 5 — Welcome Home, Brother (Week 4)** *Scene:* Philemon hugging Onesimus at the door of his house, a letter in Philemon's hand; church members smiling in the background. *Caption:* "... no longer as a slave, but... as a dear brother." — Philemon 16 *Coloring conversation:* Is there anyone you need to forgive? How does Jesus forgive us?

🖍️ **Coloring page 6 — Book Name Page: 13 Envelopes** *Design:* Thirteen envelopes arranged like a staircase, each with a book name in bubble letters (Romans → Philemon) and a tiny symbol (road, heart, muscle, fruit, helmet, smile, crown, cloud, hammer, thumbs-up, open book, blocks, handshake). *Caption:* "Thirteen Letters from Paul — Books 45–57!"

> **Printable book-name coloring sheet and word search: see `../printables/phase-11-printables.html`**

Activities & Crafts

✂️ 1. Gift Box Verse Craft (Week 1)

- **Supplies:** Small square cards, wrapping paper scraps, ribbon, glue, markers; a folded "box" template (cube net) for older kids
- **Steps:** 1) Fold or glue a paper "present" with a flap that opens. 2) Under the flap write "It is the gift of God" (Ephesians 2:8) or "Jesus." 3) Decorate with ribbon.
- **Ages:** *Little Lambs:* flap card with a cross sticker inside. *Explorers:* write the verse. *Older:* write the four Romans Road verses on the four sides of a cube.
- **What it teaches:** Grace is a free gift.

✂️ 2. Armor of God Paper Suit (Week 2)

- **Supplies:** Large paper grocery bags (breastplate), paper plates (shields), sentence strips (belts and helmets), aluminum foil, markers, tape
- **Steps:** Make each piece, label it, and "suit up." Take a class photo of your "army of God."
- **Ages:** *Little Lambs:* make just the shield and helmet. *Explorers:* all six pieces. *Older:* write a matching verse or real-life use on the back of each piece.
- **What it teaches:** Ephesians 6:10–18.

✂️ 3. Joy Jar (Week 3)

- **Supplies:** Small plastic jars or cups, colored paper strips, stickers, markers
- **Steps:** 1) Decorate the jar with "Rejoice!" 2) Write or draw things that give you joy, plus one hard thing where you can still trust Jesus. 3) Take it home and add a strip each day.

- **Ages:** *Little Lambs:* draw pictures. *Older:* add a Bible verse strip each day from Philippians.
- **What it teaches:** Philippians 4:4; 1 Thessalonians 5:16–18.

✂️ 4. Write-a-Letter Station (Week 4)

- **Supplies:** Stationery, envelopes, stickers, pens, wax-seal stickers (red)
- **Steps:** Kids write a "Paul-style" letter: 1) Greeting ("Grace and peace to you..."), 2) Thanks ("I thank God for you because..."), 3) Encouragement (a verse), 4) Goodbye ("The grace of the Lord Jesus be with you"). Send to a missionary, a shut-in church member, a grandparent, or a friend.
- **Ages:** *Little Lambs:* draw a picture and dictate one sentence to a helper. *Ambassadors:* write to a younger kid in the class.
- **What it teaches:** Paul's letter format; encouraging others.

✂️ 5. Fruit of the Spirit Bracelet

- **Supplies:** Pipe cleaners or elastic cord, beads in 9 colors (one per fruit), color key card
- **Steps:** String nine beads; as each is added, name the fruit and a way to show it.
- **Ages:** *Little Lambs:* big beads, 3 fruits (love, joy, peace). *Older:* all nine with a memory challenge.
- **What it teaches:** Galatians 5:22–23.

✂️ 6. Paul's Letter Map

- **Supplies:** Map from Phase 10, 13 tiny envelope stickers, string
- **Steps:** Stick an envelope on each city that got a letter; draw a line from Rome (where Paul was in prison) to the cities that got prison letters.
- **What it teaches:** Real letters to real places; connects Acts and the letters.

Word Puzzles

Word scramble

1. SAMNOR
2. CEGAR
3. YJO
4. ALPU
5. RRAOM
6. TFHIA
7. MHTOTYI
8. TSITU
9. RTTLEE
10. OMNIESSU
11. VLOE
12. TIRFU
13. CEJOIER
14. NAESPHIES

15. MLEOPHNI

Answer key: 1. ROMANS 2. GRACE 3. JOY 4. PAUL 5. ARMOR 6. FAITH 7. TIMOTHY 8. TITUS 9. LETTER 10. ONESIMUS 11. LOVE 12. FRUIT 13. REJOICE 14. EPHESIANS 15. PHILEMON

Fill-in-the-blank story

Word bank: letters, grace, gift, love, armor, joy, chains, coming back, Timothy, young, Onesimus, brother

> Paul wrote thirteen _____ in the Bible. He said we are saved by _____, which is a free _____ from God. To the church in Corinth, he wrote that the greatest thing is _____. To the Ephesians, he said to put on the _____ of God. Even in _____, Paul was full of _____. He told the Thessalonians that Jesus is _____ _____. He told his friend _____ not to let anyone look down on him because he was _____. And he asked Philemon to welcome _____ back as a dear _____.

Answers: letters, grace, gift, love, armor, chains, joy, coming back, Timothy, young, Onesimus, brother

Match the book to its picture / summary

Book	Picture / Summary
1. Romans	A. 🍎 The fruit of the Spirit
2. 1 Corinthians	B. 🤝 A runaway welcomed home
3. Galatians	C. 🛣️ The road to salvation — God's free gift
4. Ephesians	D. 👑 Jesus is over everything
5. Philippians	E. ❤️ "Love is patient, love is kind"
6. Colossians	F. ⛑️ The armor of God
7. 1 Thessalonians	G. 😄 Rejoice, even in chains
8. 1 Timothy	H. ☁️ Jesus is coming back
9. 2 Timothy	I. 👍 Be an example even when young
10. Philemon	J. 📖 "All Scripture is God-breathed"

Answers: 1-C, 2-E, 3-A, 4-F, 5-G, 6-D, 7-H, 8-I, 9-J, 10-B

Questions for Every Age

Little Lambs (ages 4–6)

1. What is the best gift God ever gave? (Jesus!)

2. How can you be kind this week?
3. What makes you joyful?
4. Who can you say "I forgive you" or "I'm sorry" to?
5. Who can you draw a picture or "letter" for to show God's love?

Explorers (ages 7–10)

1. How would you explain "grace" in your own words?
2. Which fruit of the Spirit do you see in your mom, dad, or a friend?
3. Which piece of God's armor would help you at school?
4. How can you have joy on a bad day?
5. How can you set an example for younger kids?

Trailblazers (ages 11–13)

1. Why is it hard to accept a gift we didn't earn?
2. Where do you see "Corinth problems" (arguing, pride, cliques) in your world?
3. What worries can you turn into prayers this week (Philippians 4:6)?
4. How does knowing Jesus "holds all things together" help when life feels like it's falling apart?
5. What would it look like to "finish the race" of faith well?

Ambassadors (ages 14–17)

1. If salvation is by grace, why does the way we live still matter?
2. How should 1 Corinthians 12 shape the way you see people with different gifts or personalities?
3. Where do you find your contentment — and is it in Christ or in circumstances?
4. Who is an "Onesimus" in your life — someone you need to welcome or forgive?
5. Who is your "Timothy" (someone younger you can mentor) and who is your "Paul" (someone older who mentors you)?

🧠 Big Questions for Ambassadors (apologetics & worldview)

1. **"Didn't Paul invent Christianity and change Jesus' simple message?"** *Suggested answer:* Paul consistently points back to what he *received* from others (1 Corinthians 15:3 — "what I received I passed on to you"), including the early creed about Jesus' death, burial, resurrection, and appearances. Paul met with Peter and James (Galatians 1:18–19; 2:9), who agreed with his message. Jesus Himself taught grace (Luke 18:9–14), His death as a ransom (Mark 10:45), and the inclusion of the nations (Matthew 28:19). Paul explains Jesus — he doesn't replace Him.
2. **"If we're saved by grace and not by works, doesn't that let people do whatever they want?"** *Suggested answer:* Paul anticipated this objection: "Shall we go on sinning so that grace may increase? By no means!" (Romans 6:1–2). Grace doesn't just forgive; it transforms (Titus 2:11–12). A person who truly receives grace is given a new heart and the Holy Spirit (Ephesians 2:10; Galatians 5:22–25). Good works are the fruit of salvation, not the root.
3. **"Why didn't Paul just say slavery was wrong?"** *Suggested answer:* Paul wrote to small, powerless house churches inside an empire where slavery was everywhere, and a call to violent revolt would likely have ended in mass executions. But Paul planted truths that undermine slavery: he condemned "slave traders" (1 Timothy 1:10), taught that in Christ "there is neither

slave nor free" (Galatians 3:28), encouraged slaves to gain freedom if they could (1 Corinthians 7:21), told masters they too have a Master in heaven and must treat slaves justly (Colossians 4:1), and asked Philemon to receive Onesimus "no longer as a slave... but as a dear brother" (Philemon 16). Those seeds grew — many Christian abolitionists like William Wilberforce and Frederick Douglass appealed to the Bible's teaching that every person bears God's image. It's honest to admit that some people have twisted the Bible to defend slavery; the Bible's own story points toward freedom and dignity.

End-of-Phase Review & Celebration

Review game plan (last Sunday)

Time	Activity
10 min	Welcome + Paul's Letters Song + full Cumulative Chant (57 books)
15 min	🎮 Letter Sort Showdown (mixed-age teams)
10 min	Favorite video replay + "Which letter was it from?" quiz
15 min	Oral check-off stations (Ambassadors help)
15 min	Write-a-Letter Station finish + "Mail Call" (deliver letters to each other)
10 min	Sealed Scroll badge ceremony, Bible Passport stamps, prayer

Oral check-off checklist

Little Lambs

- [ ] Says "It is the gift of God."
- [ ] Says the section name: "Paul's Letters!" and "Thirteen letters from Paul!"
- [ ] Names 3 of Paul's letters (e.g., Romans, Titus, Philemon) with motions
- [ ] Tells one thing Paul wrote (love, joy, armor, forgive...)

Explorers

- [ ] Says Ephesians 2:8
- [ ] Says all 13 of Paul's letters in order
- [ ] Spells all 13 (Philippians and Colossians count double!)
- [ ] Sorts them into "churches" and "friends"

Trailblazers

- [ ] Says Ephesians 2:8–9 from memory
- [ ] Says all 57 books in order (two "helps" allowed)
- [ ] Gives the "one word" for each of Paul's letters
- [ ] Names the prison letters and pastoral letters

Ambassadors

- [ ] Says Ephesians 2:8–10 and explains grace vs. works
- [ ] Says all 57 books in order with no help
- [ ] Teaches one Paul letter (summary, key verse, motion) to a younger kid
- [ ] Explains the Romans Road in their own words

🛂 Bible Passport stamp

Stamp: a **blue envelope with a red wax seal** and the words "PAUL'S LETTERS — 13 — BOOKS 45–57."

🏅 Badge description — The Sealed Scroll

A royal-blue badge showing a rolled scroll tied with a red ribbon and a white quill pen crossing it. Around the edge: "LETTERS FROM PAUL · SAVED BY GRACE · 57 of 66."

📜 Certificate wording

> **Purpose Church Sunday School Bible Explorer Certificate — Phase 11: Letters from Paul**
>
> This certifies that _____ has learned the **thirteen letters of Paul** — Romans through Philemon — and can say the books of the Bible from **Genesis to Philemon — 57 of 66!**
>
> "For it is by grace you have been saved, through faith—and this is not from yourselves, it is the gift of God." — Ephesians 2:8
>
> Awarded the **Sealed Scroll Badge** on _____ (date).
>
> Teacher: _____

Take-Home Family Page

Dear Parents and Families,

This month your child learned the **13 letters Paul wrote** to churches and friends — Romans through Philemon. We talked about grace (God's free gift), love (1 Corinthians 13), the armor of God (Ephesians 6), joy even in hard times (Philippians), Jesus' return (Thessalonians), and forgiveness (Philemon). Your child now knows **57 of the 66 books** of the Bible — only 9 to go!

This month's verse: "For it is by grace you have been saved, through faith—and this is not from yourselves, it is the gift of God." — Ephesians 2:8 **Little Lambs:** "It is the gift of God."

🎵 **This month's song** (tune: *"Old MacDonald Had a Farm"*):

> Paul wrote letters to the church, thirteen letters — WHOA! Romans, First and Second Corinthians, thirteen letters — WHOA! Galatians here, Ephesians there, Philippians, Colossians — everywhere! First and Second Thessalonians, thirteen letters — WHOA! *(Verse 2: Paul wrote letters to his friends… First and Second Timothy… Titus here and Philemon there!)*

🍽️ **Dinner-table questions**

1. What is grace? Can you think of a time someone gave you something you didn't earn?
2. Which piece of the armor of God do you need most this week?
3. How can our family "rejoice always," even on hard days?

🏠 **Family activity — "A Letter Like Paul's"** As a family, write a letter of encouragement to someone — a grandparent, missionary, teacher, neighbor, or someone who's sick. Use Paul's pattern: greeting ("Grace and peace to you!"), thanks, a Bible verse, and a blessing. Mail it or deliver it together!

📺 **Videos to watch at home** (search on YouTube; parents, please preview):

- **@SharefaithKids** — search "armor of God" or "fruit of the Spirit": https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=armor+of+God
- **@BibleJourneyTV** — search "Paul": https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Paul
- **@bibleproject** — "Overview: Romans," "Overview: Ephesians," "Overview: Philippians" (best for ages 11+): https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Overview+Philippians

Next month: "Faith, Hope & Forever" — the last 9 books, a whole-Bible review, the Bible Bowl, and Graduation Sunday!